

Sticky Date Pudding with Caramel Sauce ~ A Microwave Marvel

Yield:

- Serves 6–8 (or one determined person with a big spoon)

Time:

- 25 minutes prep | 10–13 minutes cook | 5 minutes rest (plus 2 minutes to resist eating it straight from the bowl)
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Main Pudding Ingredients

- 1 medium carrot, cut into long quarters (yes, carrot — trust the process)
 - 1 medium green apple, cut into quarters
 - 200g pitted dates, roughly chopped (sticky fingers guaranteed)
 - $\frac{3}{4}$ cup boiling water
 - 1 tsp bicarbonate of soda (the magic fizzer)
 - 100g butter, softened (soft as your resolve not to eat the batter)
 - $\frac{3}{4}$ cup brown sugar
 - $\frac{1}{4}$ cup caster sugar
 - 2 eggs (70g each)
 - $1\frac{1}{4}$ cups self-raising flour
 - $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp cinnamon
 - Icing sugar & thickened cream, for serving (aka “mandatory toppings”)
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Caramel Sauce

- $\frac{3}{4}$ cup brown sugar
 - 40g butter
 - 150ml cream
 - 1 tbsp orange liqueur (fancy optional — but oh-so-worth it)
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Method

1. Lightly grease a 2L microwave-safe glass bowl. Set it aside — it's about to become a national treasure.
 2. Shred the carrot and apple using a rotary slicer — or a grater, if you enjoy workouts disguised as baking prep.
 3. Place the dates and boiling water in a saucepan. Bring to a boil, stir in the bicarb soda and enjoy the fizz — it's basically kitchen fireworks.
 4. Attach a flat beater to your mixer. Cream the butter and sugars on Speed 4 for about 3 minutes — until fluffy enough to sleep on.
 5. Add the eggs one at a time, beating for 2 minutes after each — good things come to those who wait.
 6. Fold in the cooled carrot, apple, dates, flour, and cinnamon. Mix on Speed 1 just until combined. No need to beat it like it owes you money.
 7. Pour the batter into the prepared bowl, cover with plastic wrap, and microwave on Medium High (650W) for 10–13 minutes. Let it stand for 5 minutes — consider this its beauty nap.
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Caramel Sauce

1. Combine all the sauce ingredients in a microwave-safe bowl.
 2. Cook on High for 5 minutes, stirring every minute (your kitchen will now smell better than any scented candle could dream of).
 3. Let it stand to thicken. Try not to taste-test *too* much before serving — or don't, we're not judging.
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To Serve

- Dust the pudding with icing sugar — because life's better with a little snowfall.
 - Drench it in warm caramel sauce like it owes you rent.
 - Serve with thickened cream and a satisfied sigh.
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Microwave Tips

- Tested in an 800W microwave. If your microwave is fancier, adjust — but don't get cocky.
- Letting it rest for 5 minutes ensures it's moist, tender, and worth the wait.

Cooked once. Nailed it. Always repeated.

- Overcooking leads to sad pudding. Be kind. Watch it closely.

✦ **Final Sweetness**

"Sweetness, sealed with a prayer — and maybe a second helping."